

National Scheduled Caste and Scheduled Tribe Hub (NSSH)

[Detailed, project-ready scheme information | Government of India – Ministry of MSME](#)

Important: This document is a consolidated explanatory guide based on official Ministry of MSME, NSIC, PIB and NSSH sources. Benefit availability, application windows and operational conditions should be verified on the official portal before applying.

1. Overview

The National Scheduled Caste and Scheduled Tribe Hub (NSSH) is an initiative of the Ministry of Micro, Small and Medium Enterprises (MSME), Government of India. It was formally launched in October 2016 to strengthen the capacity of SC/ST entrepreneurs, promote an entrepreneurship culture and help SC/ST-owned micro and small enterprises participate in government procurement and mainstream markets.

A central purpose of NSSH is to support the public procurement objective under which Ministries, Departments and Central Public Sector Enterprises are expected to procure at least 4% of their total annual procurement from SC/ST-owned Micro and Small Enterprises, subject to the applicable policy and rules.

2. Main objectives

- Promote entrepreneurship among Scheduled Caste and Scheduled Tribe communities.
- Enhance the competitiveness, capacity and sustainability of SC/ST-owned enterprises.
- Help SC/ST enterprises participate in government tenders and public procurement.
- Support vendor development, mentoring, handholding and business networking.
- Facilitate credit linkages and technology/plant and machinery upgradation.
- Provide skill development, entrepreneurship development and awareness programmes.
- Improve access to exhibitions, marketing channels, e-commerce and institutional buyers.
- Create and share reliable information about SC/ST entrepreneurs and enterprises.

3. Who is treated as an SC/ST enterprise?

The revised guidelines define SC/ST enterprises broadly as follows:

- In a proprietary Micro or Small Enterprise, the proprietor must belong to the SC or ST community.
- In a partnership enterprise, SC/ST partners must hold at least 51% of the shares/ownership in the unit.
- In a private limited company, at least 51% of the shares must be held by SC/ST promoters.

The applicant should also satisfy the relevant MSME and scheme-specific conditions. Udyam Registration and valid caste/ownership documents are generally important for verification.

4. Major support components

A. Special Credit Linked Capital Subsidy Scheme (SCLCSS)

- Provides a capital subsidy of 25% for eligible SC/ST-owned Micro and Small Enterprises for purchase of eligible plant, machinery or equipment through institutional finance.
- Commonly stated subsidy ceiling: up to ₹25 lakh, subject to the applicable guidelines and eligible investment limits.
- Supports technology upgradation, modernization and improvement in productivity and quality.

- Eligibility, eligible machinery, financing route, exclusions and claim procedure must be checked in the latest SCLCSS guidelines.

B. Capacity building and training

- Skill development and entrepreneurship development programmes.
- Training in business management, finance, compliance, tendering, pricing, quality and marketing.
- Trade-specific toolkits may be provided after successful completion of eligible training programmes.
- Training may be delivered through government institutions, autonomous bodies, training institutions and partner organizations.

C. Marketing and public procurement support

- Awareness and support for participation in government procurement.
- Vendor Development Programmes (VDPs) connecting SC/ST enterprises with CPSEs and institutional buyers.
- Support for exhibitions, buyer-seller meets, trade fairs and market-linkage activities.
- Guidance on tender documentation, registration, product presentation and procurement readiness.
- Support to improve visibility of SC/ST enterprises among government and institutional buyers.

D. Credit and financial facilitation

- Facilitation of credit linkages with banks and financial institutions.
- Handholding for preparing business proposals and understanding finance requirements.
- Guidance regarding applicable credit schemes, institutional finance and documentation.
- Where specifically permitted, reimbursement/support may be available for eligible bank-related charges.

E. Registration, certification and fee reimbursement support

- Support may include reimbursement of eligible fees relating to government e-commerce portals, testing, bank loan processing, bank guarantee, NSIC-related registration or other approved services.
- Some operational summaries mention support for GeM, e-Khadi, Tribes India, MSME Mart and similar government or approved e-commerce platforms.
- Reimbursement percentages, caps, eligible portals, timing and documentary requirements can change; confirm the latest operational circular before spending money.

5. Implementation structure

- The Ministry of MSME is the nodal Ministry for the scheme.
- The National Small Industries Corporation (NSIC), a public sector undertaking under the Ministry of MSME, has been associated with implementation and delivery.
- National SC-ST Hub Offices (NSSHOs) provide mentoring, handholding, outreach and enterprise support.
- Government departments, CPSEs, training institutions, industry associations, banks and other partners may support implementation.

The Ministry announced 15 NSSH offices, including locations such as Chennai, Bengaluru, Mumbai, Pune, Hyderabad, Kolkata, Guwahati, Ranchi, Lucknow and others. Availability of services should be confirmed with the official NSSH portal or the concerned office.

6. Typical eligibility and documents

Typical eligibility indicators include:

- Applicant/promoter belongs to the SC or ST community.
- Enterprise is an eligible Micro or Small Enterprise and is SC/ST-owned as required.
- Enterprise has valid Udyam Registration or another registration accepted under the applicable component.
- Enterprise is engaged in eligible manufacturing or service activity where required; trading-only activities may be excluded for particular benefits.
- Applicant satisfies the age, ownership, finance, activity, registration and other component-specific requirements.

Common documents may include:

- Udyam Registration certificate.
- PAN card of the enterprise/proprietor/company.
- Valid caste certificate of proprietor/promoters/partners as applicable.
- Ownership and shareholding documents, partnership deed or incorporation documents.
- Bank account details and cancelled cheque.
- Loan sanction/disbursement documents for credit-linked assistance.
- Purchase invoices, quotations and machinery details for subsidy-related claims.
- Training, registration, fee-payment and reimbursement proofs wherever relevant.

7. How to apply – general process

- 1 Visit the official NSSH portal: www.scsthub.in.
- 2 Create an account or use the registration/sign-up facility where available.
- 3 Enter enterprise, promoter, caste, ownership, contact and Udyam details.
- 4 Select the relevant support component, such as training, marketing, procurement, reimbursement or credit facilitation.
- 5 Upload the required documents and submit the request.
- 6 Respond to verification queries and attend training, meetings or assessment activities if required.
- 7 Maintain invoices, certificates, bank records and other proof until the assistance is fully processed.

The exact online workflow may differ by component and may include NSIC/NSSH office verification. Registration on the portal alone does not guarantee approval or subsidy.

8. Public procurement importance

NSSH is closely connected with the Government's public procurement policy for Micro and Small Enterprises. The scheme seeks to help SC/ST enterprises become procurement-ready by improving registration, product quality, tender knowledge, pricing, documentation, buyer connections and delivery capability.

For a business wishing to supply government departments or CPSEs, useful preparation includes Udyam Registration, relevant product/service classifications, GeM onboarding where applicable, GST and PAN compliance where applicable, quality/testing certificates, bank details, digital signatures and a complete tender-response process.

9. Scheme period and current-status caution

The revised NSSH guidelines available from the Ministry cover the 15th Financial Cycle, FY 2021–22 to FY 2025–26, and state applicability up to 31 March 2026. The revised guideline documents also contain differing outlay figures across versions: an earlier Ministry-hosted version states ₹438 crore, while a later 15 May 2025 revised document states ₹588 crore. This should be treated as a document-version issue and verified against the latest official sanction/continuation order.

Because the current date is after 31 March 2026, applicants should verify whether a continuation, extension, successor guideline or component-specific operational circular is in force before relying on any benefit.

10. Official sources and useful links

Revised NSSH Guidelines – Ministry of MSME:

<https://msme.gov.in/sites/default/files/Revised-NSSH-Guidelines.pdf>

Later revised guideline document dated 15 May 2025:

https://clcss.dcmsme.gov.in/Manual/Revised_NSSH_Guidelines_dated_15052025.pdf

Official NSSH portal:

<https://www.scsthub.in/>

MSME Ministry:

<https://msme.gov.in/>

NSIC:

<https://www.nsic.co.in/>

National SC-ST Hub dashboard:

<https://www.dashboard.msme.gov.in/scsthub.aspx>

PIB information on NSSH Centres:

<https://www.pib.gov.in/PressReleasePage.aspx?PRID=2003867>

MSME scheme booklet:

<https://www.msme.gov.in/static/uploads/2026/05/3040dc36fd7023c4d4d1f647ee816165.pdf>

11. Website-project data fields you can use

- Scheme name: National Scheduled Caste and Scheduled Tribe Hub (NSSH).
- Ministry: Ministry of Micro, Small and Medium Enterprises.
- Implementing agency: NSIC / NSSH offices, as applicable.
- Target group: SC/ST-owned eligible Micro and Small Enterprises and prospective entrepreneurs.
- Support categories: subsidy, training, marketing, procurement, credit linkage, mentoring, registration and reimbursement.
- Primary portal: scsthub.in.
- Documents: revised guidelines, application instructions, eligibility, benefits, FAQs, contact details and dashboard.
- Important disclaimer: benefits are component-specific and subject to current guidelines, budget, verification and availability.

Prepared as a consolidated explanatory PDF for educational/project use. Always verify the latest official notification before presenting a benefit as currently open.